

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE POST OF
TOURIST OFFICER UNDER TOURISM DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM
(JULY-2026)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

PART-A
(24 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it. Attempt all questions.*

1. Write a precis of the following passage by reducing to one third of its original length and give suitable title. (14)

If a business activity does not require anything special to be done, it is not entrepreneurship. In fact a person cannot be called an entrepreneur unless he introduces something new, something different, in his venture. This is known as innovation, that is, doing something different from others.

Entrepreneurs are constantly on the look out for something unique to fulfil the needs or wants of people. They may or may not be inventors of new products or new methods of production, but they are able to foresee the possibility of making use of an invention for business. Others who come to know about the same invention may not be capable of thinking about its practical usefulness in business, or they may not have the ambition or self-confidence to take advantage of it.

In a competitive market, an entrepreneur can succeed only through innovation. Innovation need not necessarily be something big or dramatic. A simple adjustment to an existing product, providing service without extra charge, using colourful packaging, or selling a product in packets of different weights may all be profitable innovations. However, if similar things are done by many producers and sellers, entrepreneurs must think of other types of innovations. No wonder imagination is often more important than knowledge for innovative thinking. An entrepreneur must possess imagination as well as the ability to think creatively.

Take the case of fruit juice. Nowadays fruit juice is sold in small cartons instead of bottles so that one can carry it easily and discard the container after use. This is an innovation. Let us consider another example. You may have heard of Henry Ford, who established the Ford Motor Company in the United States. He did not invent the automobile, but he applied new methods of mass production and produced passenger cars at low cost so that many people could afford them.

2. Write a letter to the editor of a renowned daily newspaper in your state sharing your views on the preservation of historical sites in the state. (10)

PART- B
(76 MARKS)

All questions carry equal mark of 1.

This Section should be answered only on the OMR Response Sheet provided.

Notes regarding Negative Marking :

- (i) *There will be penalty (negative marking) for every wrong answer given by a candidate in the MCQ type questions.*
 - (ii) *For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, one-third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.*
 - (iii) *If a candidate gives more than one answer to one question, it will be treated as wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above for that question.*
 - (iv) *If any question is left blank i.e. no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.*
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Direction (Question Nos. 1 - 10): Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

A sustainable livelihood refers to the means by which individuals and communities earn a living while maintaining their ability to meet future needs. It is not merely about generating income but also about ensuring that economic activities do not deplete natural resources or damage the environment. A livelihood is considered sustainable when it can withstand external shocks such as natural disasters, economic downturns, or social conflict and continue to provide adequate support for people's well-being.

In many rural areas, people depend heavily on agriculture, forestry, fishing, and other natural-resource-based activities. However, population growth, climate change, and environmental degradation have increased pressure on these resources. As a result, many communities face challenges in maintaining stable incomes and food security. To address these issues, governments and development organizations encourage practices such as organic farming, water conservation, skill development, and diversification of income sources.

Sustainable livelihoods also emphasize social inclusion and community participation. Local people are encouraged to take part in decision-making processes that affect their lives and resources. Access to education, healthcare, credit facilities, and technology can further strengthen livelihoods by increasing people's capabilities and opportunities. Ultimately, sustainable livelihood strategies aim to reduce poverty, improve resilience, and promote long-term economic, social, and environmental well-being.

1. What is the primary focus of a sustainable livelihood?
 - (a) Maximizing short-term profits.
 - (b) Earning a living while meeting present and future needs.
 - (c) Increasing industrial production.
 - (d) Reducing population growth.
2. According to the passage, a sustainable livelihood should be able to:
 - (a) Depend entirely on government support.
 - (b) Avoid all economic activities.
 - (c) Withstand external shocks and continue supporting people's well-being.
 - (d) Focus only on environmental protection.

3. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge to sustainable livelihoods?
- (a) Climate change (b) Population growth
(c) Environmental degradation (d) Technological advancement
4. The word 'deplete' in the passage most nearly means:
- (a) Increase (b) Restore
(c) Exhaust (d) Protect
5. Which activities do many rural communities depend on for their livelihoods?
- (a) Software development and banking (b) Agriculture, forestry and fishing
(c) Manufacturing and mining only (d) Tourism and aviation
6. Which of the following is suggested as a way to promote sustainable livelihoods?
- (a) Excessive use of chemical fertilizers
(b) Water conservation and skill development
(c) Dependence on a single source of income
(d) Overexploitation of natural resources
7. Sustainable livelihoods emphasize:
- (a) Social exclusion
(b) Privatization of all resources
(c) Restricting access to education
(d) Community participation in decision-making
8. What is one of the ultimate goals of sustainable livelihood strategies?
- (a) Reducing poverty and improving resilience
(b) Increasing dependence on natural resources
(c) Encouraging migration to cities
(d) Limiting community participation
9. Access to which of the following can strengthen livelihoods?
- (a) Education and healthcare (b) Credit facilities and technology
(c) Both (a) and (b) (d) None of the above
10. Which statement best summarizes the passage?
- (a) Sustainable livelihoods focus on environmental conservation.
(b) Rural livelihoods should depend on agriculture.
(c) Sustainable livelihoods combine economic security, environmental protection, and social inclusion to improve long-term well-being.
(d) Climate change is the only threat to livelihoods.

Direction (Question Nos. 11 - 20): Identify the part of speech of the underlined word in the following sentences:

11. I usually study in the library for an hour after the class.
- (a) verb (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) preposition

12. He is judged not by what he says but by his deed.
(a) conjunction (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) preposition
13. When I was a student, I went to the gym everyday.
(a) conjunction (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) preposition
14. I was planning to buy a car, but wait !. The price just doubled overnight.
(a) conjunction (b) interjection
(c) adjective (d) preposition
15. The lecture interested the student.
(a) verb (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) preposition
16. Don't give a lame excuse.
(a) verb (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) noun
17. The two countries went to war with one another over oil prices.
(a) pronoun (b) preposition
(c) adjective (d) noun
18. She brought me round to her views.
(a) verb (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) noun.
19. The movie is a comedy but rather a dull one.
(a) verb (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) noun
20. He called me after he had finished eating.
(a) conjunction (b) verb
(c) adjective (d) preposition

Direction (Question Nos. 21 - 30): Choose the correct preposition from the alternatives given to complete the sentences:

21. Her novel approach to the data set is predicted _____ several flawed assumptions.
(a) in (b) with
(c) on (d) by
22. The applicant is found deficient _____ the quantitative skills required for the fellowship.
(a) in (b) at
(c) on (d) of

23. Despite his initial resistance, he eventually acquiesced _____ the Minister's demands.
(a) with (b) to
(c) for (d) by
24. He spent the week taking long walks _____ the picturesque trails.
(a) on (b) by
(c) along (d) at
25. It is imperative that we hold _____ our core values during this period of change.
(a) to (b) on
(c) onto (d) by
26. She has a remarkable aptitude _____ learning foreign languages.
(a) with (b) for
(c) to (d) on
27. The witness complied _____ the court's instructions.
(a) to (b) by
(c) at (d) with
28. The cat jumped _____ the table and knocked over a vase.
(a) on (b) up
(c) onto (d) at
29. The river flows _____ the valley for nearly fifty kilometers.
(a) in (b) through
(c) on (d) onto
30. The new policy is consistent _____ the organization's long-term objectives.
(a) with (b) for
(c) in (d) about

Direction (Question Nos. 31 - 40): Choose the correct option from the alternatives given below to complete each sentence:

31. The Prime Minister invested the new establishment _____ judicial authority.
(a) over (b) on
(c) with (d) to
32. He was vexed _____ the behaviour of his son.
(a) with (b) at
(c) on (d) to
33. He always connives _____ the faults of his children.
(a) with (b) at
(c) on (d) about

34. I will support your proposal _____ it is financially viable.
(a) though (b) provided that
(c) so that (d) even though
35. He acted _____ he knew everything.
(a) like (b) as if
(c) because (d) therefore
36. We continued our journey _____ the road was flooded.
(a) yet (b) but
(c) although (d) whereas
37. Hardly _____ students understood the complexity of the theorem.
(a) some (b) any
(c) every (d) all
38. _____ research has been conducted on this topic.
(a) Most (b) Much
(c) Many (d) All
39. There isn't _____ water left in the tank.
(a) much (b) many
(c) more (d) some
40. I invited Sarah and Esther but _____ of them came.
(a) either (b) neither
(c) none (d) both

Direction (Question Nos. 41 - 45): Choose the word nearest in meaning to the underlined word or phrase :

41. The children became clamorous when they heard the ice-cream truck approaching.
(a) silent (b) moderate
(c) loud (d) excited
42. Education is a potent tool for breaking the cycles of poverty.
(a) infirm (b) weak
(c) important (d) strong
43. The story has a whimsical charm that appeals to both children and adults.
(a) logical (b) playful
(c) absurd (d) magical
44. We laughed at their puny attempt to sneak into the theatre.
(a) robust (b) strange
(c) feeble (d) flawed

45. The leader showed remarkable courage in the face of adversity.

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| (a) enmity | (b) opposition |
| (c) resentment | (d) hardships |

Direction (Question Nos. 46 - 50): Choose the correct meaning of the idioms underlined:

46. They will finish the construction on schedule when pigs fly.

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| (a) to confuse others | (b) something impossible |
| (c) to outshine others | (d) through unfair means |

47. The government was accused of sitting on its hands during the crisis.

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| (a) do nothing | (b) make irrelevant effort |
| (c) celebrate noisily | (d) to aggravate the situation |

48. Although he did not want to, he finally coughed up the admission fee.

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| (a) provide money dishonestly | (b) frustratingly |
| (c) pay in a hurried way | (d) pay unwillingly |

49. The speaker went off on a tangent, making it difficult for the audience to understand the topic.

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| (a) talk nonsense | (b) rebuke someone |
| (c) go off - topic | (d) expresses anger |

50. They could not heap coals of fire on his head.

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| (a) stab him in the back | (b) support him blindly |
| (c) put him to shame | (d) make him confess |

Direction (Question Nos. 51 - 56): Choose the correct vocabulary to complete the sentence:

51. During the winter, many deer become _____ and die because of food shortage.

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| (a) emancipated | (b) enunciated |
| (c) elevated | (d) emaciated |

52. The conspirators met _____ in order to plot a revolt against the ruler.

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| (a) clandestinely | (b) wickedly |
| (c) precociously | (d) belligerently |

53. It would be difficult for one so _____ to be led to believe that all men are equal and that we must disregard race, colour and creed.

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| (a) democratic | (b) prejudiced |
| (c) obsolete | (d) emotional |

54. Rent control restrictions on small apartment owners may unfortunately _____ rather than alleviate the housing problem.

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| (a) resolve | (b) diminish |
| (c) castigate | (d) aggravate |

55. Most of the issues discussed here in the meeting were trivial and only a few were _____.
(a) interesting (b) practical
(c) significant (d) irrelevant
56. Questions will be answered by a _____ of experts.
(a) panel (b) staff
(c) bunch (d) band

Direction (Question Nos. 57 - 61): Pick out the correct clause/phrase of the words underlined in the given sentences.

57. A man is being questioned by the police.
(a) adverb phrase (b) noun phrase
(c) adjective phrase (d) verb phrase
58. The brilliant young scientist from Aizawl won the prestigious national innovation award.
(a) adverb phrase (b) adjective phrase
(c) verb phrase (d) noun phrase
59. The proposal which was submitted by the Superintendent last week has been approved.
(a) adverbial clause (b) adjective clause
(c) co-ordinate clause (d) noun clause
60. Since you insist, I shall accompany you.
(a) Noun Clause (b) Adjective Clause
(c) Adverb Clause (d) Adjective Phrase
61. All depends on how it is done.
(a) Noun Clause (b) Adjective Clause
(c) Adverb Clause (d) Adverb Phrase

Direction (Question Nos. 62 - 66): Choose the correct transformation of sentences as directed:

62. How wisely she handled the crisis! (Assertive Sentence)
(a) How wise she was handling the crisis.
(b) Did she handle the crisis wisely?
(c) She handled the crisis wisely.
(d) The crisis was handled by her wisely.
63. There is no success without hard work. (Affirmative Sentence)
(a) There is success with hard work.
(b) Hard work guarantee success.
(c) Hard work is necessary for success.
(d) Success comes only through hard work.

64. Everyone appreciated the proposal. (Negative Sentence)

- (a) No one appreciated the proposal.
- (b) Nobody failed to appreciate the proposal.
- (c) Nobody appreciate the proposal.
- (d) Everyone did not appreciate the proposal.

65. It is impossible to solve the problem without cooperation. (Interrogative Sentence)

- (a) Can anyone solve the problem without cooperation?
- (b) Is it possible to solve the problem without cooperation?
- (c) Is it not impossible to solve the problem without cooperation?
- (d) Will they solve the problem without cooperation?

66. The boy is innocent. (Exclamatory Sentence)

- (a) Why! The boy is innocent!
- (b) What is an innocent child!
- (c) Alas, The child is innocent!
- (d) How innocent the boy is!

Direction (Question Nos. 67 - 71): Out of the four alternatives suggested, select the one which best expresses the same meaning in Direct/Indirect Speech:

67. The lady inquired if he was now quite well again.

- (a) The lady inquired, "Are you now quite well again?"
- (b) The lady inquires, "Are you quite well again now?"
- (c) "Were you quite well again now?", inquired the lady.
- (d) The lady asked, "Have you been quite well now?"

68. 'What a rare article milk is, to be sure, in London!' said Mr. Scrooge with a sigh.

- (a) Mr. Scrooge sigh saying that milk is a rare article in London.
- (b) Mr. Scrooge exclaimed milk was, to be sure, a rare article in London.
- (c) Mr. Scrooge exclaimed with a sigh that milk was, to be sure, a rare article in London.
- (d) Mr. Scrooge sighed, saying that milk was, to be sure, a rare article in London.

69. He said that though he had come, it was against his will.

- (a) He said, "Though I come, it is against my will."
- (b) He said, "Though I have come, it is against my will."
- (c) He said "Though I came, it was against my will."
- (d) He said, "Though I come, it is not my will."

70. 'When do you intend to pay me?' he enquired.

- (a) He enquired when I intend to pay him.
- (b) He enquired when I do intend to pay him.
- (c) He enquired when I intended to pay him.
- (d) He enquired when I intend to paid him.

71. 'My hour is come,' thought he. 'Let me meet death like a man.'
- (a) He thought his hour is come and decided to meet his death like a man.
 - (b) He thought his hour has come and said that he would meet his death like a man.
 - (c) He thought he would meet his death like a man as his hour has come.
 - (d) He thought that his hour had come and decided to meet his death like a man.

Direction (Question Nos. 72 - 76): Fill in the blanks using the correct tense form from the alternatives given:

72. The invitees _____; they are sitting in the room.
- (a) arrived
 - (b) are arriving
 - (c) have arrived
 - (d) had arrived
73. She _____ books most evenings.
- (a) is reading
 - (b) read
 - (c) has been reading
 - (d) reads
74. No sooner _____ then it started raining.
- (a) did I reached
 - (b) I reached
 - (c) did I reach
 - (d) had I reached
75. We _____ significant advances in renewable energy by the end of this century.
- (a) will have made
 - (b) will be making
 - (c) would make
 - (d) will make
76. When we went to the theatre, the movie _____.
- (a) has already started
 - (b) started
 - (c) had already started
 - (d) was already starting

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